

Lead to Exceed Manager Guide



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One or more of your direct reports is/are participating in RealPage's six-week development program for manager to director levels, Lead to Exceed. As the participant's manager, you play a critical role in ensuring results from their learning and development activities. This guide will help you support and reinforce the lessons from the Lead to Exceed.

This Manager Guide is organized as follows:

Program Overview

- Explains overall program structure and course roadmap to provide you with a preview of what your employee will experience in and outside the classroom.

Before the Session

- Provides an action list of what you can do to ensure participants arrive at the session prepared and motivated.

Overview of Course Content

- Presents key course content to help you understand and reinforce the use of the concepts, skills, and techniques introduced in the course.

After the Session: Reinforcing and Supporting Application

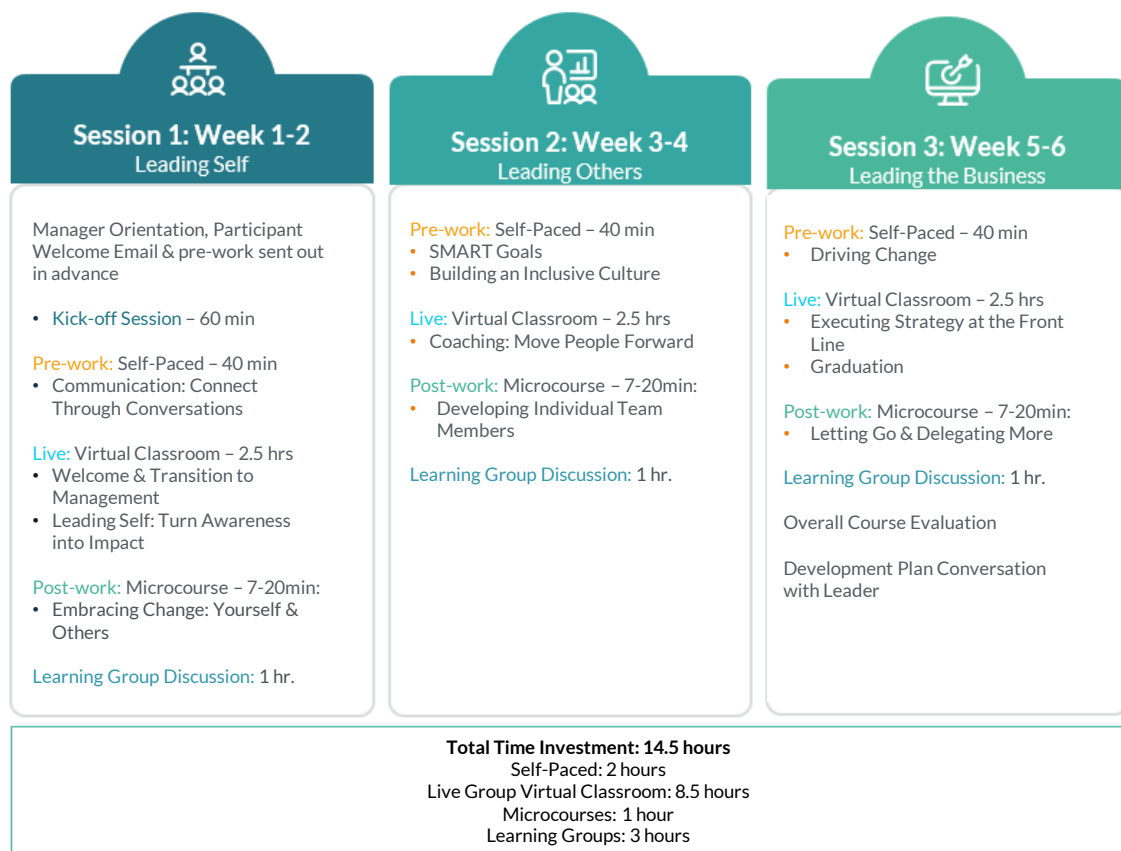
- Provides an action list you may refer to and use at any time to help participants successfully apply what they've learned on their job.
- Development planning with the participant after the session

Program Overview

Lead to Exceed is designed to provide RealPage leaders (manager to director levels) with essential leadership skills to drive performance and results. It is also a prerequisite for higher leadership development programs.

The program is divided into three sessions: Leading Self, Leading Others and Leading the Business. It uses a combination of learning methodologies including self-paced pre-work, micro-courses or e-Learning, and learning group discussions to ensure networking and peer-to-peer coaching.

Session Roadmap



Before the Session

Help the participants come to the sessions prepared and motivated.

- Encourage participants to complete all required pre-work.
- Provide the time and resources needed for participants to attend each session in its entirety.
- Listen for and openly discuss resistance to attend a session. Work with your leaders to find ways to overcome barriers.
- Schedule a meeting with each person to be held immediately after training, if possible, to follow up and discuss how the person will apply what they learned.

Overview of Course Content

Session 1: Leading Self Weeks 1-2

Pre-Work

Communication: Connect Through Conversations

Overview

Leaders work eight hours, often more, every day. During that time, they face the challenge of communicating and connecting with the people they lead through conversations that usually focus on business goals. Good leaders also use these as opportunities to acknowledge people's feelings and concerns by connecting on a deeper level. Communication: Connect Through Conversations explores that deeper connection, the head and heart—the whole person—and helps participants gain insights and learn techniques and skills to increase their confidence in successfully navigating those “in the moment” conversations, even the tough ones.

In this course, participants will learn to:

- Conduct conversations that achieve their intended business goals.
- Communicate and respond in ways that meet the unique personal needs of team members and others.
- Recognize and react to emotions (theirs and others') present in work situations.
- Use a technique to provide meaningful, and supportive feedback

Communicating with Head and Heart

Through two tools, learners gain insight into how well they recognize their own emotions as well as the emotions that others express. They recognize that they can improve their emotional intelligence through the application of a powerful set of communication skills, and this can have a strong impact on their success as a leader.

Interaction Essentials

The **Interaction Essentials** comprise two sets of communication skills: Key Principles and Interaction Guidelines.

Key Principles address the heart and meet people's personal need to feel valued and respected in interactions. They are:

- Maintain or enhance **self-esteem**.
- Listen and respond with **empathy**.
- Ask for help and encourage **involvement**.
- **Share** thoughts, feelings, and rationale. (to build trust)
- Provide **support** without removing responsibility. (to build ownership)



Interaction Guidelines—Open, Clarify, Develop, Agree, and Close—provide a structure that ensures leaders engage the head and achieve the business goals—that is, the practical needs that are the reason for the conversation.

STAR and STAR/AR Feedback

Participants learn about STAR, an approach to giving complete and specific feedback that reminds the leader to describe:

- **ST—Situation or Task.** What was the problem, business opportunity, challenge, or task?
- **A—Action.** What was said or done to handle or respond to the situation or task?
- **R—Result.** What happened, for better or worse, because of the person's or team's actions, and what was the impact or consequence of that result?

An additional AR component for providing developmental feedback includes:

- An **Alternative Action**—something the person or team could have said or done differently.
- The enhanced Result that the alternative action might have produced.

Live Virtual Class

Transition to Management

According to Harvard Business School's extensive research on career transitions, making the leap from individual contributor to people manager counts among the most challenging transitions in business life. People often move into a new role and start "doing" without investing the time to learn about the new role. Many managers fail because they do not recognize the transition that must occur as they shift their roles. They move forward doing what they do best—delivering excellent individual contributor work.

In this session, participants learn about the nine mistakes new people managers often make and discuss ways to overcome them.

Turn Awareness into Impact

Overview

A more accurate self-perception has long been a predictor of success in life and as a leader. Self-awareness arms leaders with knowledge that enables them to make better decisions, build stronger relationships, and know which of their qualities to leverage and which to mitigate. On the other hand, a lack of self-awareness can be an obstacle to the growth of a leader. This course helps leaders to gain insights to more intentionally be their best selves.

In this course participants will:

- Increase internal self-awareness by identifying their emotions, talents and aligning their values with those of RealPage's.
- Identify their emotional triggers and learn tactics to manage their response.
- Identify their leadership talents to leverage for greater positive impact.

Internal Self-Awareness Model

The internal self-awareness model is explained through the analogy of a tree:

- Values are shown as the roots because they are the foundation of people's behavior, actions, and decisions.
- Emotions are the trunk—where the heart is.
- Branches represent talents because they can grow and multiply over time. The course provides activities, content, and guidance to explore these three areas.



Values

Learners will review RealPage's Core Values. Participants will identify a core value that resonates with them the most and share ways they can advocate it within their teams.

Emotions

With emotional intelligence positioned as a key factor in a leader's success, learners explore the emotional triggers that can lead them to react with unwanted or inappropriate behavior.

In a variety of activities, participants discuss and share response management tactics for controlling their immediate reactions when triggered. With coaching from their peers, learners develop a self-directive—a plan for what they'll do differently when triggered to avoid behavior they might later regret.

My Self-Directive

Whenever I experience _____ (trigger/feeling/thought)

I will avoid _____ (unwanted response)

and will do this instead: _____ (response management tactic)

Talents

Before the session, learners complete a self-insight tool that helps them see where their most natural talents lie in a model of six core leadership talents. Learners explore the six talents in greater depth and then identify the talents they rated highest and most energizing for themselves.



They recognize how awareness of their talents can enhance their impact as a leader. In a small group activity, learners get coaching on a workplace challenge from peers who are stronger in different talents and thus gain the benefit of their diverse perspectives. Learners commit to take one action related to applying their talents.

Post-Work Micro-course: Embracing Change – Yourself and Others

Change is universal. However, it manifests itself in very different ways depending on the situation, the environment, the people, and the timing.

This course will help participants:

- Discover their position in the Change IQ Continuum.
- Learn the three phases' people go through before they can embrace change.

Three Phases of Change

- Disorientation – people feel confused, anxious, uncertain or concerned about the change.
- Reorientation – people make discoveries, learn and begin to feel greater sense of control over their situation.
- Integration – people adjust. What was once unsettling is now normal. The change has become part of the routine. They are in the final phase before fully embracing change.

Session 2: Leading Others Weeks 3-4

Pre-Work

SMART Goals

Overview

A successful performance process starts with setting clear and achievable goals. When team members are in control of their work processes and outcomes, they are more engaged and strive for better results.

This course will help participants to shift from the traditional approach of command leadership and engage their team members to share responsibility for their performance.

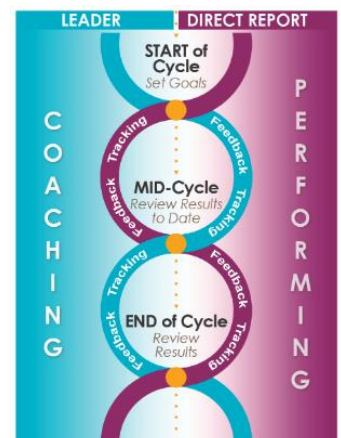
They will learn to:

- Demonstrate shared ownership for setting goals, gathering data, tracking progress, and reviewing results.
- Compose performance goals that are specific, measurable, attainable, relevant, and time bound.
- Evaluate how team members are accomplishing their goals based on performance data.
- Use essential interaction skills to meet personal and practical needs during performance discussions.
- Provide ongoing coaching and feedback throughout the performance cycle.

Introduction

Leaders are introduced to a model which depicts shared ownership for managing performance and the roles and responsibilities of each person throughout an entire performance cycle.

At the start of the cycle, leaders and direct reports work together to set goals, and then review results during the cycle. While the leader provides ongoing coaching on the direct report's performance, both are responsible for tracking progress and sharing feedback.



SMART Performance Goals

Leaders learn how to write effective performance goals using the SMART criteria:

- Specific—defines specific results to be achieved.
- Measurable—defines quantity, cost, or quality metrics to determine progress.
- Attainable—allows the goal to be challenging, yet the person can still ensure results.
- Relevant—supports the achievement of team or organizational goals.
- Time bound—specifies a due date, time frame, or frequency rate.

Gathering Data

Learners are introduced to two types of data they need to gather to track their direct reports' performance—operational and behavioral:

- Operational data provides information on direct reports' progress on **what** they are expected to achieve (their SMART goals). This type of data can come from sources such as calendars, project timelines, reports, and feedback surveys.
- Behavioral data provides information on **how** direct reports are accomplishing their goals. This type of data can be tracked by gathering feedback from direct reports and others in the form of a STAR (Situation/Task, Action, Result).

Reviewing Results

The Interaction Essentials—Interaction Guidelines and Key Principles—are skills your leaders learned in the Leading Self module to help them meet personal and practical needs during discussions. While all Interaction Essentials are valuable, some are more helpful when setting goals and when reviewing results.

Live Virtual Class

Coaching: Move People Forward

Overview

The need to coach can happen at any time. In these moments, leaders should have a go-to approach for coming alongside people and helping them achieve a goal. This course shows leaders how to move people forward by creating a relationship built on trust, meeting their personal and practical needs right where they are, and energizing them into action.

In this course, participants will learn to:

- Recognize and nurture the potential within others to grow and change.
- Flex their approach to meet the unique needs of each person, whether they're coaching for success or for improvement.
- Guide, inspire, support, and empower in the moment.
- Ask questions, connect at a human level, and energize into action.

Insights and the Impact of Coaching

Coaches do make an impact—good or bad. To have a positive impact, leaders must approach coaching with the mindset that people can grow and change. They also must be willing to open and disclose thoughts, feelings, and rationale to build the trust that's needed in a good coaching relationship. Through self-insight tools, learners explore where their tendencies lie in these areas and how they can adjust their words and actions to co-

Ask, Connect, Energize

Whether coaching happens in the moment or is planned, there's an easy-to-remember approach: Ask, Connect, and Energize (ACE).



- Ask is about asking questions to clarify details and involve people in thinking things through on their own.
- Connect is about leaning in and cultivating trust through empathy and sharing to better understand where people are coming from.
- Energize is about building ownership with your support and igniting confidence with esteem. Learners practice ACE through a variety of engaging activities that challenge them on what they would say and do to use each technique.

Coaching Conversation Skills

Sometimes coaching is more involved and requires planning: That's where the Interaction Essentials come in. These two sets of communication skills—Interaction Guidelines and Key Principles—provide structure to a conversation.



Interaction Guidelines

Open, Clarify, Develop, Agree, Close

Key Principles Open - the personal "human" needs that people have

Esteem, Empathy, Involvement, Share, Support

Post-Work Micro-course:

Developing Individual Team Members

Overview

Development is a shared responsibility between both the leader and the person being developed. In this microcourse, participants will learn that successful development involves three phases – assessing development goals, determining ways to acquire learning, and providing opportunities to apply the learning on the job.

Session 3: Leading the Business Weeks 4-6

Self-Paced Pre-Work

Driving Change

Overview

Resistance to change is a normal reaction, even when it will ultimately benefit an employee, their teams, and the organization.

Successfully completing Driving Change will enable learners to:

- Prepare to effectively communicate the business rationale for change.
- Use three actions to accelerate implementation.
- Recognize the nature of resistance and use a set of skills to respond to it.
- Determine aspects of the change that can be controlled.
- Use essential interaction skills to conduct effective discussions to move closer to embracing change.

Change Accelerators

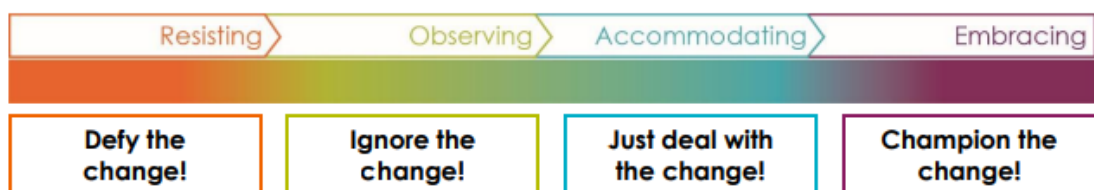
Participants are introduced to three Change Accelerators they can use to implement change more quickly for their own change situation:



- Describe what's changing and why. Explaining the business reasons for and expected benefits of the change helps people understand and accept it.
- Seek reactions and feelings. Drawing out and then responding to people's concerns can move them past any emotional barriers that are holding them back.
- Regain a sense of control. Learning that they can control or at least influence aspects of the change can help people begin to accept it more quickly.

Change Reactions Continuum

It's important to recognize people's reactions to change and respond in a way that helps them move forward. In this micro course, learners explore four common reactions and determine where their team members are on the continuum.



Personal and Practical Needs of Change

Participants learn how to use the Interaction Essentials – Key Principles and Interaction Guidelines—to meet the personal and practical needs of individuals during change.

Live Session

Executing Strategy at the Frontline

Overview

- Communicate how their priorities align with the organization's strategic goals.
- Focus their and their team's time, attention, and energy on the highest priorities.
- Determine how to track progress and assess outcomes for each priority.
- Apply best practices to hold people accountable for the work they've assigned them.

Participants are introduced to three elements of strategy execution:

- **Focus**
- **Measurement**
- **Accountability**

The majority of activities in the session guide participants to explore these elements within the context of their own top priorities; thus, the benefits are specific to each person. The Strategy Execution Tool helps leaders visualize and assess the status of top priorities, related measurements, and accountable individuals.

Focus

Put critical priorities first.

When a leader and his or her team are focused, they consistently take actions and invest time and energy on the critical priorities that contribute to accomplishing the organization's goals. They recover quickly from distractions while balancing daily operational needs, customer demands, and financial requirements.

- Focus is prioritizing a few important things and communicating these items to the team.
- These priorities get more attention, more review, and more discussion because they're the most critical for success.

Measurement

Track progress and assess outcomes.

Leaders cannot manage what they don't measure. It's important to establish both progress and outcome measures for key priorities:

- Progress measures and monitors trends that can enable leaders to predict their ability to reach a goal or objective.
- Outcome measures describe what success will look like. They measure what has been achieved after the fact compared to the desired outcome.

Adhering to the following criteria will ensure that metrics will be sound:

Objective: from a perspective that people can agree on.

- Actionable; yielding information that people can act on.
- Consistently trackable over time.
- Easy to implement; readily available.
- Quantifiable; stated as a number or percentage.
- Relevant; yielding information to reveal trends, progress, and barriers.

Accountability

Assign work and reinforce responsibility.

Leaders often struggle with enforcing accountability. They are responsible for holding people accountable in appropriate ways, ensuring that the right people do the right things at the right times.

Four accountability best practices are:

- **Hold one person accountable for each progress measure.** Leaders should avoid “joint accountability,” which leads to inaction or confusion. (However, in some cases it is appropriate for multiple team members to have an identical individual measure, such as a quota or rate.)
- **Communicate accountability, including consequences.** A leader needs to discuss expectations with each person, including the consequences if the work exceeds or falls short of the measures outlined.
- **Set monitoring and/or follow-up methods.** The leader should discuss with each person the ways in which the work will be monitored and clarify the expectation that he or she will follow up regularly. The leader also should encourage people to speak up when obstacles arise.
- **Offer feedback and coaching.** The leader should reassure each team member that they will provide feedback and coaching to help ensure the person is successful.

Post-work Micro-course:

Letting Go and Delegating More

Overview

In this microcourse, learners will learn the benefits of delegation to oneself, their team and the organization. They will also discover how to deal with their own hesitations to delegating and the learn some best practices to delegating effectively.

After the Session: Reinforcing and Supporting Application

Reinforce and support your team member's application of skills in the workplace.

- **Encourage Accountability.** Hold participants accountable for consciously using the Interaction Essentials to meet personal and practical needs in their interactions.
- **Offer Support.** Discuss your direct report's application plan and offer your support in implementing their plans.
- **Measure Progress.** Work with people to identify and agree on ways to measure their progress and success in applying their newly learned skills and knowledge.
- **Use Collaboration Tools.** Take advantage of technology to sustain learning and development. For example, share links to articles, videos, and other online tools that reinforce the importance and impact of providing and responding to effective feedback.
- **Address Barriers.** Discuss barriers that are preventing people from applying new skills and help them plan how to overcome them.
- **Follow Up.** Schedule a meeting immediately after training, if possible, to follow up on how the person will apply what they learned. Regularly check in on formal or informal discussions to ensure people are applying the new skills and that their use of them is positively affecting performance. Then, incorporate feedback on their skills in their performance reviews.
- **Recognize Successes.** As participants begin to consciously apply what they learned, acknowledge and appreciate the impact—big or small—their work is having on business success.

After the Session: Reinforcing and Supporting Application

Reinforce and support your team member's application of skills in the workplace.

Development Planning

To further support the learners' career growth and development, the participant will be asked to complete a Development Plan and will set up a meeting to review the development plan with you.

The following questions can help you throughout the conversation:

- Why is this development goal important?
- How will you accomplish the developmental goal? Identify specific behaviors, experiences, projects, assignments, or deliverables to achieve this objective.
- What resources and/or support do you need to accomplish the developmental goal (i.e., time/money/tools/equipment/people)?
- How can I help you with this development goal?

For any questions, please email:
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